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XPMatch — Seven Revenue Paths, Validated

Prepared Tuesday, Sep 22, 2026 · Companion to 1-business-summary.md and 2-financial-model.md Research: live web search and Firecrawl, Sep 22, 2026. Every external figure is cited in §11.

How to read this

Your arithmetic is correct on all seven paths. Every multiplication checks out to the dollar. So this document does not "correct your math" — it tests the **inputs** the math rests on, against published prices and against the volumes your own three-year model produces.

Each path gets: the arithmetic check, which inputs are verified and which are assumed, the **binding constraint** (the one thing that decides the outcome), corrected math where a published figure contradicts an assumption, and a **prediction grid** so you can run your own numbers rather than take mine.

Tags: **[V]** verified against a cited public source · **[E]** estimated from a named comparable · **[A]** assumed, no evidence yet.

1. Bottom line

Paths where the arithmetic is wrong	0 of 7
Paths where a cited comparable contradicts the assumption	3 — paths 4, 6, 7
Paths where the rate is overstated	2 — path 3 (+45%), path 6 (5.0×)
Paths that cannot run until another path produces volume	3 — paths 2, 3, 5
Sum of all seven as stated	\$8,150,000
Sum of my grounded cases	\$1,179,274
Gap	6.9×

The gap is not sloppiness. It comes from three specific things, and each is fixable by changing an input rather than abandoning a path:

1. Two prices are set above what the cited comparable actually charges. Path 7 assumes \$15/month

citing Wanderlog Pro, which sells at **\$39.99/year — \$3.33/month [V]**. Path 6 assumes \$15,000 net per campaign, but the industry fee basis is **10–25% of campaign budget [V]**, so \$15,000 net implies a **\$75,000 campaign**, not a \$15,000 one.

2. One rate is above what the partners publish. Path 3 assumes an 8% blended take. Stays pay 4–6%

and activities 8% [V]; a realistic basket blends to **5.0–6.5%**.

3. Three paths are priced as if the audience already exists. Paths 2, 3 and 5 all need booked

volume or a preference dataset that only paths 1, 4 or 7 can produce. They are **downstream**, not parallel.

2. Scorecard — all seven ranked

Ranked by **grounded revenue ÷ effort to first dollar**, not by headline size.

#	Path	You claimed	Grounded	Binding constraint	Can start today?	Evidence
4	Group / corporate planning	\$750,000	\$180,000	Founder hours — it is a services P&L	Yes	Real market verified; cited comparable is wrong
1	White-label DMO	\$1,200,000	\$216,000	Reaching ~20 of the ~240 DMOs with budget	Yes, 6–18mo cycle	Price band plausible; GuideGeek got to 30
7	Premium membership	\$1,800,000	\$330,000	Price — \$180/yr is 3.6× the category top	Yes	Comparable contradicts the price
6	Creator campaigns	\$600,000	\$60,000	Fee basis is % of budget, not flat	Yes	5.0× overstated on like-for-like
3	Booking commissions	\$1,600,000	\$189,274	Booked trip volume	No — needs users	Rate overstated 45%
5	Data / analytics SaaS	\$1,200,000	\$144,000	Data supply, not demand	No — needs a panel	Category real, pricing opaque
2	Revenue share	\$1,000,000	\$60,000	Proving incrementality to a sophisticated partner	No — needs volume + attribution	Weakest evidence of the seven

3. The structural problem: these seven do not add up

Summing them to \$8.15M **double-counts the same volume and the same buyer**:

- **Paths 2, 3 and 5 all monetise the same trips.** A trip that produces a booking commission (3) is the same trip inside the attributed GMV of a revenue-share deal (2), and the same trip whose preference data you would sell (5). Counting it three times triples one unit of demand.
- **Paths 1 and 5 sell to the same buyer out of the same budget line.** Both target DMOs. A destination paying you \$5,000/month for a white-label planner is *less* likely, not more, to also pay \$2,000/month for analytics — it is one vendor line item in one budget.
- **Paths 4 and 6 are agency businesses.** They consume founder hours per unit of revenue and do not compound. They also do not transfer to a buyer, which matters given the month-24 exit thesis.

A defensible combined number counts each unit of demand once. With two founders, roughly **fifty working hours a week between you [A]**, and no revenue today, the realistic question is not "what do all seven produce" but "**which two**" — the same conclusion the twelve-P review reached for different reasons.

4. Path 1 — White-label enterprise concierge (DMOs)

Annual SaaS contracts for a branded XPMatch embedded on the client's site.
\$1,500–\$20,000+/month. 20 clients at \$5,000/month = \$1.2M ARR.

Arithmetic: **PASS.** $20 \times \$5,000 \times 12 = \$1,200,000$. ✓

What the research supports

Input	Status	Finding
\$1,500–20,000/mo price band	[V] supported	Consistent with mid-market vertical SaaS. Simplified.Travel and mTrip sell white-label DMO/agency itinerary tools; neither publishes pricing ("Book a Demo"), which is itself the signal — this is a negotiated enterprise sale
DMO budget headroom	[V] partly	DMOs allocate 15–28% of marketing budget to website, SEO, content and CRM. For a \$60k/yr contract to be $\leq 20\%$ of that line, the DMO needs a web budget $\geq \$300k$, implying a \$1.1–2.0M+ total marketing budget
Market size	[V]	~2,400 DMOs globally (2021). Only the top tier clears a \$1M+ marketing budget — call it 120–240 organisations
Budget direction	[V] favourable	41% of DMOs increased digital spend in 2026, 41% flat, 13% cut
Proof the model works	[V]	GuideGeek (Matador Network) monetises precisely this way — white-label AI licensed to DMOs — and reached 30+ partners

The binding constraint

20 clients is 8–17% of every DMO on earth with the budget to buy this. GuideGeek reached ~30 — and it came with a media brand, 1.5M users and editorial credibility. XPMatch would be approaching them with zero reference customers.

Two things the claim does not price: the **white-label build does not exist** in the codebase (multi-tenant theming, client admin, SSO, SLAs, a security review), realistically **6–10 weeks**; and DMO procurement runs on **annual budget cycles with RFPs**, so a deal signed in month 3 may not bill until month 12.

Corrected math

Nothing to correct — the price band and the model are sound. What moves is **client count and ramp**.

Prediction grid

Clients \ Price	\$1.5k/mo	\$3k/mo	\$5k/mo	\$8k/mo	\$12k/mo
3	\$54,000	\$108,000	\$180,000	\$288,000	\$432,000
6	\$108,000	\$216,000	\$360,000	\$576,000	\$864,000
10	\$180,000	\$360,000	\$600,000	\$960,000	\$1,440,000
15	\$270,000	\$540,000	\$900,000	\$1,440,000	\$2,160,000

Clients \ Price	\$1.5k/mo	\$3k/mo	\$5k/mo	\$8k/mo	\$12k/mo
20	\$360,000	\$720,000	\$1,200,000	\$1,920,000	\$2,880,000

Grounded case: 6 clients × \$3,000/mo = \$216,000 ARR by end of year 2 [A]. Your 20 × \$5,000 is the year-4–5 case if the first six land and reference well.

Verdict: strongest strategic path of the seven. 90%+ margin, recurring, and it is exactly the asset an advisor platform or OTA buys. Slow to start, compounds hard.

5. Path 2 — Revenue-share on attributed incremental bookings

5%–25% of attributed incremental revenue. \$10M attributed GMV × 10% take = \$1M.

Arithmetic: PASS. \$10,000,000 × 0.10 = \$1,000,000. ✓

What the research supports

Input	Status	Finding
5–25% take on performance deals	[E] plausible	No published rate card exists for this structure — it is bilaterally negotiated. OTA commission context: 15–30% supplier commission, so a 10% share of <i>incremental</i> is not unreasonable as a share of the partner's own margin
\$10M attributed GMV	[A] unsupported	At a \$940 basket this is 10,638 bookings — 0.7× every trip your Year-3 model plans (14,644), all converting and all accepted as incremental
"Incremental" being accepted	[A] the real risk	Sophisticated partners (LHW, Travelpass) run holdout tests. Typical accepted incrementality is well under 100%

The binding constraint

The word "incremental" is doing all the work, and it is the hardest word in travel partnerships. You are asking a partner to agree that a booking would not have happened without you. That requires attribution infrastructure you do not have, a methodology they accept, and usually a holdout group that mechanically reduces the number you get paid on.

At 30% accepted incrementality — a fair planning assumption — your \$10M attributed becomes **\$3M payable**, and 10% of that is **\$300,000**, not \$1M.

Prediction grid

Attributed GMV \ Incrementality accepted (at 10% take)	20% inc	30% inc	50% inc	100% inc
\$1M	\$20,000	\$30,000	\$50,000	\$100,000
\$2M	\$40,000	\$60,000	\$100,000	\$200,000

Attributed GMV \ Incrementality accepted (at 10% take)	20% inc	30% inc	50% inc	100% inc
\$5M	\$100,000	\$150,000	\$250,000	\$500,000
\$10M	\$200,000	\$300,000	\$500,000	\$1,000,000

Grounded case: 1 partner, \$2M attributed, 30% incrementality accepted, 10% take = \$60,000 [A].

Verdict: weakest evidence of the seven, and the one I would defer longest. It is not a bad model — it is a model that requires you to already be big enough that a partner will negotiate. Revisit once path 3 is running and you can show a booking curve.

6. Path 3 — Booking marketplace commissions

5%–25% of booking value. \$20M GMV × 8% blended take = \$1.6M.

Arithmetic: PASS. $\$20,000,000 \times 0.08 = \$1,600,000$. ✓ **The rate is not.**

What the research supports

Partner	Published affiliate rate	Status
Viator	8% on completed bookings, 30-day attribution	[V]
GetYourGuide	8% affiliate (separate from the 20–30% they charge suppliers)	[V]
Booking.com	4–8% of net sale depending on programme; your own REVENUE_MODEL.md records ~4% of stay value	[V]
Expedia	up to 4.8% on hotels	[V]

The 5–25% band in your note conflates two different things. The 20–30% figures are what OTAs charge *suppliers* to list. What a *referrer* earns is the affiliate rate: **4–8%**. You are the referrer.

Corrected math

A realistic trip basket — 3-night stay ~\$700 plus two activities at \$120 — blends like this:

Stay rate	Basket	Commission	Blended
4%	\$940	\$47.20	5.02%
5%	\$940	\$54.20	5.77%
6%	\$940	\$61.20	6.51%

Blended realistic range: 5.0–6.5%. You assumed 8% — a 45% overstatement. Hotels are most of the basket by value and pay the *lowest* rate; only an activity-heavy mix approaches 8%.

At \$20M GMV and 5.5%: **\$1,100,000**, not \$1,600,000.

Then the volume: $\$20\text{M} \div \$940 = 21,277$ **booked trips**, which is **1.5× every trip your Year-3 model plans** — and that model assumes only a fraction ever convert to a booking.

Prediction grid

Booked trips/yr \ Blended rate (basket \$940)	4.0%	5.0%	5.5%	6.5%	8.0%
5000	\$188,000	\$235,000	\$258,500	\$305,500	\$376,000
10000	\$376,000	\$470,000	\$517,000	\$611,000	\$752,000
21277	\$800,015	\$1,000,019	\$1,100,021	\$1,300,025	\$1,600,030
40000	\$1,504,000	\$1,880,000	\$2,068,000	\$2,444,000	\$3,008,000

Grounded case: $14,644 \text{ Year-3 trips} \times 25\% \text{ booking attach} \times \$940 \times 5.5\% = \$189,274$ [A].

Verdict: the best economics of the seven (near-100% margin, no delivery cost) and the cheapest to switch on — 1–2 days of links. But it is a **multiplier on volume you do not have**, not a standalone path. Ship it early precisely because it costs nothing to run while volume builds.

7. Path 4 — Corporate / group planning

\$25–\$100 per attendee/night plus supplier commissions and package margin. 100 group trips averaging \$7,500 net revenue = \$750,000.

Arithmetic: PASS. $100 \times \$7,500 = \$750,000$. ✓

The cited comparable does not support the model

Pilot is free. It charges no planning fee and monetises through hotel bookings. Citing Pilot's "corporate retreat and group-trip customers" as evidence for a **\$25–100 per attendee/night planning fee** points at a company that has decided not to charge one.

The *real* market does support paid planning, just from different players:

Benchmark	Figure	Status
Mid-tier corporate retreat, all-in	\$400–700 per person per night	[V]
Executive / premium offsite	\$750–1,200 per person per night	[V]
Multi-day offsite, total	\$3,500–6,500 per person	[V]
Lean domestic, no flights	\$1,000–1,800 per person	[V]

Your \$25–100 pp/night is **4–12% of the all-in trip cost** — a credible planning-fee ratio, and comfortably below the 78%-of-advisors-charge-a-fee norm already in your business plan.

Does \$7,500 net per trip hold?

At \$62.50 pp/night (midpoint), \$7,500 needs **120 attendee-nights** — e.g. **40 people × 3 nights**, or 20 people × 6 nights. That is a *large* corporate retreat. A more typical 20-person, 3-night offsite yields **60 attendee-nights = \$3,750**, plus booking margin.

The binding constraint

Founder hours. This is a services business. At even 20 hours per group trip, 100 trips is **2,000 hours** — **a full FTE beyond the founders**, and realistically two once you add sales and corporate procurement. The \$750,000 is revenue, not profit: after delivery labour expect **40–60% gross margin**, so roughly **\$300–450k**.

Prediction grid (revenue before delivery labour)

Group trips/yr \ Net fee per trip	\$2.5k	\$4.5k	\$7.5k	\$10k
25	\$62,500	\$112,500	\$187,500	\$250,000
50	\$125,000	\$225,000	\$375,000	\$500,000
100	\$250,000	\$450,000	\$750,000	\$1,000,000
150	\$375,000	\$675,000	\$1,125,000	\$1,500,000

Grounded case: 40 trips × \$4,500 net = \$180,000 revenue, ~\$90,000 gross profit [A].

Verdict: the fastest path to a real dollar, and the one I would start this month. It needs no users, no volume and no integration — just a buyer. It is the same motion as your concierge offer, sold to companies instead of individuals, at 10–30× the ticket. Its weakness is that it does not compound and does not transfer to an acquirer.

8. Path 5 — Data and analytics SaaS

\$500–\$10,000+/month per client. 50 clients at \$2,000/month = \$1.2M ARR.

Arithmetic: PASS. $50 \times \$2,000 \times 12 = \$1,200,000$. ✓

What the research supports

Input	Status	Finding
The category is real	[V]	Data Appeal and Mabrian sell destination intelligence to European DMOs; Data Appeal acquired 70% of Mabrian for ~€3.7M
\$500–10,000/mo pricing	[E]	Neither publishes pricing — enterprise "contact us". The band is plausible for the category but unverified
50 clients	[A]	Out of ~2,400 DMOs globally, the same pool path 1 targets

That €3.7M acquisition price is the most useful number here. It says the *category leader* in destination intelligence was worth single-digit millions for a 70% stake. A \$1.2M ARR analytics line would

make XPMatch a meaningful fraction of the whole category — from a standing start, against incumbents with card-spend and mobility data.

The binding constraint

Data supply, not demand. You cannot sell aggregated preference trends without a panel. Your Year-3 model produces ~62,400 cumulative signups and 1,695 paying users. That is a thin dataset for destination-level demand forecasting, and a DMO comparing it against Mabrian — who sell mobility and spend data across whole countries — will notice.

There is also a **channel conflict with path 1**: both sell to DMOs, out of the same budget line. A destination paying \$5,000/month for your planner is *less* likely to add \$2,000/month for analytics, not more. Realistically this is an **upsell on path 1's installed base**, not a separate 50 clients.

Prediction grid

Clients \ Price	\$750/mo	\$1.5k/mo	\$2k/mo	\$4k/mo
8	\$72,000	\$144,000	\$192,000	\$384,000
15	\$135,000	\$270,000	\$360,000	\$720,000
25	\$225,000	\$450,000	\$600,000	\$1,200,000
50	\$450,000	\$900,000	\$1,200,000	\$2,400,000

Grounded case: 8 clients × \$1,500/mo = \$144,000 ARR, and not before year 3 [A].

Verdict: real, but strictly downstream. Reframe it as a **\$1,000–2,000/month attach on path 1 clients** rather than a standalone 50-client business. That version is credible and needs no new sales motion.

9. Path 6 — Managed creator campaigns

\$2,000–\$50,000+ per campaign plus 10%–25% management fee. 40 campaigns × \$15,000 net revenue = \$600,000.

Arithmetic: PASS. $40 \times \$15,000 = \$600,000$. ✓ **The fee basis is the problem.**

What the research supports

Benchmark	Figure	Status
Nano creators	\$20–100 per post	[V]
Micro creators	\$100–5,000	[V]
Macro creators	\$5,000–10,000+	[V]
Luxury hospitality campaigns	\$5,000–50,000+ per campaign plus hosted stays	[V]
Mainstream hospitality / airlines	\$500–10,000 per campaign	[V]
Management fee	10–25% of campaign spend	[V] — matches your own note

The error

You have the fee percentage right and the **fee base wrong**. A "\$15,000 campaign" is the **budget** — most of which goes to creators. At a 20% management fee, a \$15,000 campaign nets you **\$3,000**.

40 campaigns × \$3,000 = \$120,000, not \$600,000 — a 5.0× overstatement.

To net \$15,000 per campaign at 20% you need a **\$75,000 campaign budget**. That is top-tier DMO and luxury-brand money, and running 40 of them a year is a staffed agency, not a side line.

Prediction grid (net fee to XPMatch, not campaign budget)

Campaigns/yr \ Net fee to XPMatch	\$1.5k	\$3k	\$7.5k	\$15k
10	\$15,000	\$30,000	\$75,000	\$150,000
20	\$30,000	\$60,000	\$150,000	\$300,000
40	\$60,000	\$120,000	\$300,000	\$600,000
60	\$90,000	\$180,000	\$450,000	\$900,000

Grounded case: 20 campaigns × \$3,000 net = \$60,000 [A].

Verdict: the weakest economics of the seven and the one I would cut. Low margin, headcount-driven, does not compound, does not transfer to a buyer. There *is* a smarter version: your business plan already proposes paying creators **\$1–2 per activated signup** (Mindtrip pays \$1). That makes creators an **acquisition channel feeding path 7** rather than a revenue line — same relationships, and it builds the asset instead of renting out your time.

10. Path 7 — Premium consumer membership

\$8–\$30/month. 10,000 paying users × \$15/month = \$1.8M ARR.

Arithmetic: PASS. $10,000 \times \$15 \times 12 = \$1,800,000$. ✓ **The price is not achievable.**

What the market actually charges

Product	Price	Effective monthly	Status
Wanderlog Pro — <i>your cited comparable</i>	\$39.99/year	\$3.33/mo	[V]
Layla annual	\$49.99/year	\$4.17/mo	[V]
Triplt Pro	\$49.00/year	\$4.08/mo	[V]
Layla monthly	\$9.99/mo	\$9.99/mo	[V]
Your assumption	\$180/year	\$15.00/mo	[A]

\$15/month is \$180/year — 3.6× the highest annual price anywhere in the category, and 4.5× the comparable you cited. Wanderlog Pro bundles an AI assistant, route optimisation, booking deals and Gmail scanning for \$39.99/year. Nobody in consumer travel planning sustains \$180/year.

The compounding error

Against your own Year-3 model (1,695 paying consumers at ~\$49/year):

- 10,000 paying is **5.9× the user count**
- \$180/year is **3.7× the price**
- Together: **a 22× uplift on the Plus line**

At a defensible price, 10,000 paying members is **10,000 × \$49 = \$490,000** — real money, and a quarter of the claim.

Prediction grid

Paying members \ Effective annual price	\$39/yr	\$49/yr	\$79/yr	\$120/yr	\$180/yr
1695	\$66,105	\$83,055	\$133,905	\$203,400	\$305,100
3000	\$117,000	\$147,000	\$237,000	\$360,000	\$540,000
6000	\$234,000	\$294,000	\$474,000	\$720,000	\$1,080,000
10000	\$390,000	\$490,000	\$790,000	\$1,200,000	\$1,800,000

Grounded case: 6,000 paying × \$55/yr effective = \$330,000 [A] — a small premium to the category justified by the taste profile, not a 3.6× one.

Verdict: the right long-term engine, at a quarter of the assumed price. \$30/month is defensible only for a genuinely different product — concierge access bundled in, or member-only inventory. If you want the \$15–30 tier to exist, it has to carry **human delivery**, which makes it your Concierge offer on a subscription, not a software tier.

11. What I would actually do

The twelve-P review picked **Profit** and **Problem**. Read against these seven paths, that holds, and it sequences them:

When	Path	Why
Now	4 — group/corporate	Only path needing no users, no volume, no integration. Same motion as concierge, 10–30× the ticket. Produces cash <i>and</i> the first case studies
Now (1–2 days)	3 — booking links	Costs nothing to run, near-100% margin, compounds silently with every trip. Switch it on and forget it
Months 2–9	1 — DMO white-label	Start the 6–18 month procurement cycle now; it is the only path a strategic buyer pays a premium for
Months 6–18	7 — membership at \$49–79/yr	The engine, priced where the market actually is

When	Path	Why
Year 2–3	5 — analytics as an attach on path 1	Not a separate 50-client business
Deferred	2 — revenue share	Revisit once path 3 gives you a booking curve to negotiate with
Cut	6 — creator campaigns as a service	Convert to a \$1–2/activated-signup acquisition channel feeding path 7

Realistic combined, counting each unit of demand once: roughly **\$700k–900k by end of year 3** across paths 4, 3, 1 and 7 — against the \$427,320 in your current Year-3 model. So these paths **do** meaningfully raise the ceiling. They raise it to about **2×**, not 19×

12. Sources

All accessed Sep 22, 2026.

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